

Path to UTMB – Project Ideas

1. Data Sources

UTMB race results: official times, splits, rankings (scrapable as CSV/JSON). Splits are gold for pacing analysis.

Other races by UTMB finishers: Cross-reference UTMB starters with UltraSignup, ITRA, Strava, etc. See what type of races they did (distance, elevation, terrain).

Your own training/race data: Strava, Garmin, Coros (export via API). Focus on races + long runs.

2. Data Features to Track

Athlete profile: age, sex, previous UTMB attempts, # of ultras, longest race finished, training volume.

Race characteristics: distance, elevation gain/loss, technical difficulty, altitude, weather.

Performance metrics: finish time vs cutoff, field percentile, pace per terrain type, dropout rate.

Training metrics: weekly mileage, vertical gain, longest run, time-in-zone (Z2/Z3/Z4).

3. Analytical Angles

Benchmarking: Compare your results to historical UTMB sub-27h finishers. Example: athletes with sub-27 UTMB often had a 100k under X hours.

Progression modeling: Study how finishers improved across seasons before achieving <27h. Example: Median 100k improved ~20% pre-breakthrough.

Predictive modeling: Regression or survival analysis to estimate UTMB finish time distribution. Example: Your 100k = Xh → predicted UTMB ~29h ±2h. To reach 27h, need ~13:30h 100k.

4. Visualization Ideas

Scatter plots: Other race times (100k, 80k) vs UTMB time, with threshold lines for <27h.

Heatmaps: Race percentile → probability of <27h UTMB.

Trajectory plots: Improvement curves before UTMB breakthrough.

Personal dashboard: 'Where am I now?' vs sub-27 benchmarks.

5. Fun Extras

Training what-if simulator: Plug in planned races to predict progression.

UTMB split simulation: Model checkpoint splits under ideal vs conservative pacing.

Motivational tracker: Countdown like 'Based on your curve, sub-27 possible ~2027 if healthy and consistent.'

Closing Thoughts

This could be a mix of data science + sports analytics + personal motivation. It might evolve into a blog series ('Path to UTMB: Data Edition') or a dashboard app for progress tracking.